

Chapter 98_2 - Yiyi

After an unknown amount of time, just when Su Mo thought there was no one in the house and was preparing to turn back, a pale face appeared in the narrow gap between the door and doorframe. That face was visibly haggard, with dry and cracked lips, and uncombed hair hanging softly at her waist.

Su Mo immediately widened her eyes and grasped the doorframe.

"How is it you?" Even the veil couldn't hide her shocked expression. Apart from shock, somewhere in her heart welled up a strange feeling of loss and recovery.

"Are you ill?" Su Mo immediately noticed her abnormality and reached out to push open the door.

This exposed the woman's full appearance in the daylight. She looked as if she had been injured and bedridden, her clothes quite disheveled, her upper garment half-removed, revealing one shoulder blade wrapped in gauze. The areas not bandaged were whiter than cloud brocade, with distinct collarbones and fine sweat.

Su Mo immediately felt her earlobes burning and quickly closed the door she had just pushed open.

"Just some minor injuries, nothing serious," Ning Fuyi said. Although her heart was blooming with joy, her face still showed a weak expression. She turned and walked into the inner room, collapsing softly onto the bed.

This house was designed by Jiuying, everywhere reflecting her personal taste. The incense had a cloying fragrance, every table, chair, and case was carved with flowers, and gauze curtains hung from the bed, swaying gently with the wind from outside.

The woman lay in the disheveled bedding embroidered with mandarin ducks¹, like lotus flowers in water, causing Su Mo to only dare look with peripheral vision.

"You..." She was about to express concern with sign language but was interrupted by Ning Fuyi speaking.

"I just encountered bandits again, really nothing serious," Ning Fuyi turned her face toward the wall, her voice weak and breathless. "This place has too much sickness, I fear it might infect the young lady. Please return."

Su Mo was pure-hearted and kind, and Ning Fuyi indeed looked genuinely ill, so how could she think it was an act? Guilt immediately became irrepressible, and as her eyes drooped, the veil began to moisten from beneath her eyes.

Only then did Ning Fuyi realize she had overdone the act. She turned to get up but was pressed down by Su Mo's hand, who silently began tidying the poorly wrapped gauze for her.

When she reached the areas covered by clothing, Su Mo's hands stopped, not daring to touch the remaining skin.

The woman's body was well-proportioned and beautiful, countless times more exquisite than her own skeletal frame, Su Mo thought with sudden self-consciousness.

Why was this happening? Why was her heart beating so fast? Su Mo didn't really understand.

"It really is just a minor injury," Ning Fuyi said softly. She had indeed suffered in the demon realm - this time the so-called Earth King who came looking for trouble was much more formidable than those previous misfits. Without breaking through to the Great Vehicle Realm², she had won but barely, and indeed sustained some injuries.

However, most had healed during these past few days. She had left some superficial wounds unmedicated, hoping to use this opportunity to get close to Su Mo again.

"I'm sorry," Su Mo raised her hand. "I spoke without thinking that day and hurt you."

"I was the one who overstepped first, I can't blame you," Ning Fuyi covered her lips and coughed a few times, coughing until tears streamed down. "I wasn't angry either, it's just that urgent family matters called me away, and I had no choice but to leave."

That's good then, Su Mo thought to herself. She nodded, not knowing where to place her gaze, only able to lower it to her own knees.

Ning Fuyi stared at the small section of nose bridge exposed beneath Su Mo's veil and suddenly smiled: "You still call me 'young lady' now, as if we're very unfamiliar."

"Then what should I call you?" Su Mo looked up.

"Shall I teach you how to address me?" Ning Fuyi suddenly became interested. She supported herself on the bed edge to sit up, one hand gathering her collar, the other easily removing Su Mo's veil.

Clean peach blossom eyes³ looked at her, seeming somewhat bewildered.

"Yiyi," Ning Fuyi said with exaggerated mouth movements.

"Ye... ye..." Su Mo struggled to imitate.

"Not 'yeye' (grandpa)," Ning Fuyi shook her head repeatedly, extending her tongue as much as possible. "Yi. Yi."

"Ya... ya..." Su Mo said.

Ning Fuyi was truly at a loss. She suddenly remembered a folk method, so she pulled Su Mo's finger to place it on her own tongue tip, letting her feel the changes of the tongue when speaking.

"Yiyi," she said word by word.

Su Mo's fingertip felt the soft lips. When Ning Fuyi spoke, her tongue slid across the skin, as if something was winding along her spine, tingling and numb.

So she opened her mouth without making a sound, but her face turned completely red.

Footnotes

1. **Mandarin ducks (鸳鸯)** - In Chinese culture, mandarin ducks symbolize love and marriage because they are believed to mate for life. They are often featured in wedding decorations and romantic contexts.
2. **Great Vehicle Realm (大乘)** - One of the higher cultivation realms in this story's power system. Cultivators who reach this level possess significantly enhanced abilities.
3. **Peach blossom eyes (桃花眼)** - A Chinese term describing a particular eye shape that is considered very attractive, characterized by slightly upturned outer corners that resemble peach blossom petals.